

46°16′48″ N, 86°40′12″ E

The Continental Pole of Inaccessibility

46°16′48″ N, 86°40′12″ E. The Continental Pole of Inaccessibility: the point on land farthest from every sea — 2,560 km from the coast on average (three published calculations give 2,645, 2,510 and 2,514 km) — in the Gurbantünggüt (Dzoosotoyn Elisen) desert, Xinjiang Uygur Autonomous Region, People's Republic of China.

This is the first work born from that concept: a series of full-colour photographs, in the look of late-1970s 35 mm Kodak Ektachrome, of people who went to the beach at the place where the beach is farthest. Swimsuits, sun hats, cool boxes and towels, laid out on the dry steppe, with nobody and nothing around for thousands of kilometres.

The pole is also a question, asked in two directions.

- **Outside you** — what is your pole of inaccessibility, the point of you farthest from everyone else?
- **Inside you** — if you look inside yourself, what is there, at the point farthest from your external appearance?

I have the feeling this can go beyond these first images, and I am having conversations with people who work in different styles and formats about it.

What else can be born from this — a book, a film, a poem, a map, a monument, a ritual, an expedition? That is what the project wants to explore.

art.carlodemarchis.it/projects/pole/

Scan for the full project, the other series, photobooks and upcoming exhibitions.
Available as museum-quality fine art paper prints, editions of 10, in different sizes, on request.
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